

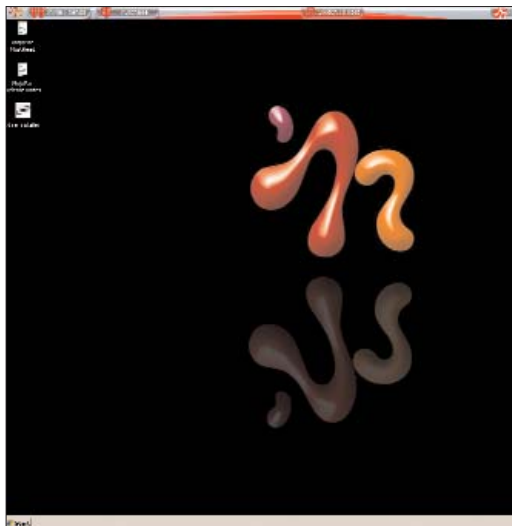
When you open My Computer from within your MojoPC, you'll notice that your USB disk shows up as the C: drive. This protects the host PC from any drastic changes that you could make, and also ensures that even the most badly-written installers won't accidentally write to the *real* C: drive—we've encountered numerous installers that automatically start installing to "C:\Program Files" without so much as asking you.

MojoPac not only protects the host PC, it also protects itself—it only gives you access to Windows' default programs, and is intelligent enough to distinguish between these and the rest of the programs installed on the host. So even if programs on the host PC are infected with viruses,

your MojoPC stays safe because it just can't run those processes.

The Experience

Working with MojoPac requires little or no grey matter at all—your USB device will autorun when you insert it (this feature only works with Service Pack 2), you log in to your MojoPC, and start working! There's a toolbar at the top that lets you switch to your host PC's desktop just in case. Another cool feature is that when a window pops up in the host PC—as happens when someone sends you an IM—you get a friendly notification in



MojoPac gives you your own virtual desktop to play around in

the tray informing you of the event.

We tried MojoPac on a Transcend 512 MB Flash drive, and we did notice that applications took a little longer to load than we'd hoped—this shouldn't have happened considering the test PC had 1 GB of RAM for it to exploit. Of course, that's when we realised that we hadn't optimised it—here's how you can...

Speed Up Your Mojo

1. In My Computer (on your Host PC), right-click on the USB drive and select Properties.
2. Under the Hardware Tab, select the drive and click on the Properties button.
3. In the dialog that pops up, you'll see that "Optimize for quick removal" is selected; change this to "Optimize for Performance."

You will now see a noticeable improvement in your Mojo performance.

You And Your Mojo

Thus far, the experience of using portable programs from your USB stick lacked the feeling of seamlessness—every PC you work on is different, so it takes time to adjust to each of them. With MojoPac, your interaction with the MojoPC is the same every time, so you're always comfortable.

If you keep carrying your work between office and home, MojoPac has obvious advantages: all your data and programs travel with you, complete



You're never out of touch with the host PC

with their settings. You can carry all your favourite applications on your MojoPac and use them at work—everything you do within your MojoPC stays confidential, and still doesn't violate any company policies: as far as the IT infrastructure is concerned, all you did was start a program.

If you're one of those unfortunate souls whose friends keep popping over to use your PC, wantonly changing your settings and running programs you don't want them to run, force them to use MojoPac! Get them to buy USB drives and install MojoPac on them. This way, they can come and use your PC's resources, but leave your programs and settings intact.

We mentioned that MojoPac lets you switch between the MojoPC and the host PC's desktop; in addition, it needs administrative access to allow the user to install applications to his MojoPC. While this is quite frustrating (letting your annoying friend switch out of Mojo into an Administrator Desktop? The horror!), there's a simple way to work around this. First, create a Guest account on your PC—cripple its privileges as much as you can. Use this account when a friend wants to log on. MojoPac will ask for an Administrator password before it starts—enter it. Now, when your friend switches out of his MojoPC, all he sees is a limited guest account—he's better off in the MojoPC!

MojoPac has also been tested with a large number of games—head over to www.mojopac.com to see which ones—so you can exploit any high-end rig you can get your hands on. Even the rigorous DRM features are going to work fine, so no worries there.

Our Recommendations

At the very least, MojoPac requires you to have a 128 MB USB 2.0 flash drive, but you're going to need more storage depending on how you want to use it. If you want to install Microsoft Office, for example, 1 GB of storage is essential—500-odd MB for the installation itself, and the rest for storage and other applications. You also need to look at how often you're going to be reading from and writing to this drive—Flash drives start to fail after a large number of read/write cycles.

Though the developers claim that MojoPac has been optimised to perform no more writes than absolutely essential, excessive use *will* have you sifting through corrupt data faster than you'd like. If you're going to turn this into a way of life, an external hard disk would be a better option, giving you the advantages of both storage space and reliability. For gaming, you should invest in a faster (and probably more expensive) drive than the rest to ensure smooth performance.

So what are you waiting for? Get installing and write to us about your Mojo experience! ■

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